

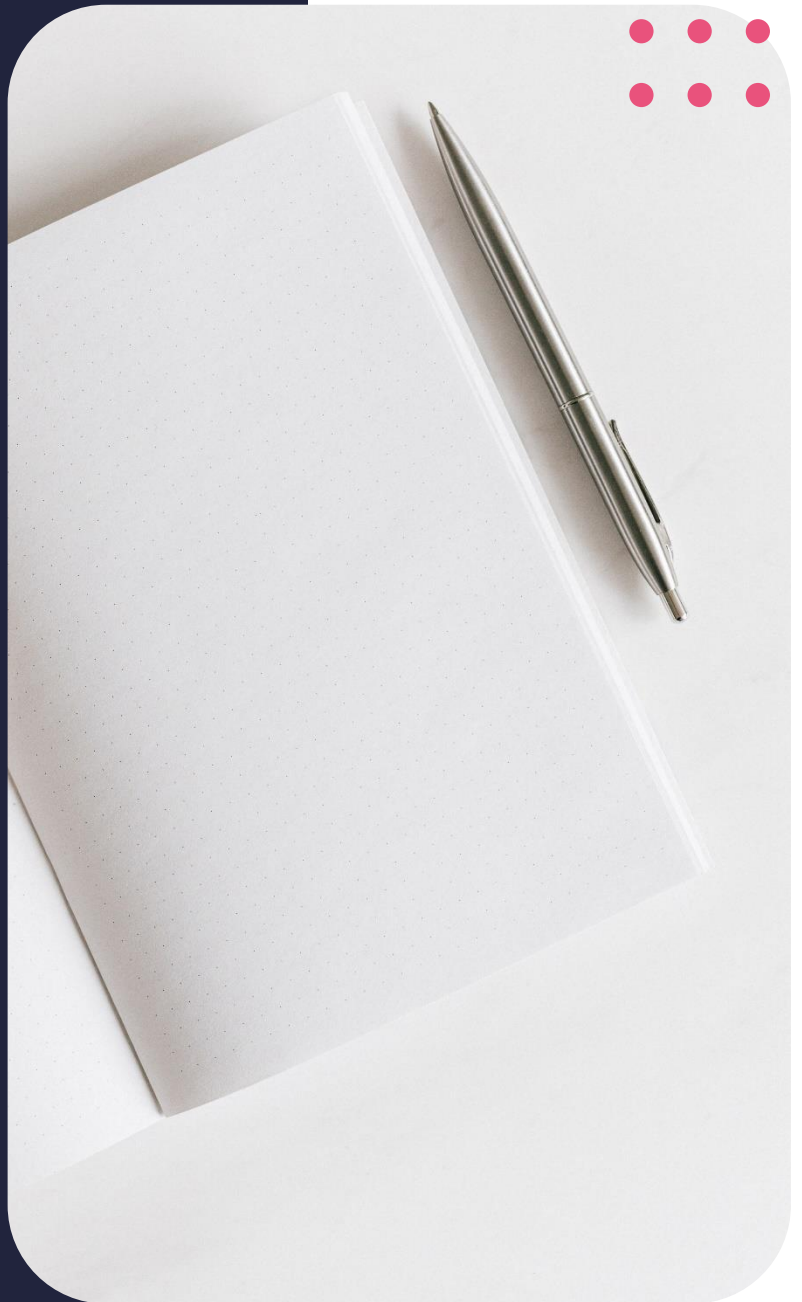
Diploma in Leadership & Management

How to Lead And Manage the Company Culture



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Lesson 7 Objectives

- Organisational culture
- Barriers to change
- Your role as the leader and manager

Lesson Introduction

“Organizational culture is a system of shared assumptions, values, and beliefs, which governs how people behave in organizations. These shared values have a strong influence on the people in the organization and dictate how they dress, act, and perform their jobs.” (Study.com)



Key reading materials

- <https://www.managers.org.uk/~media/Files/PDF/Checklists/CHK-232-Understanding-organisational-culture.pdf>
- <https://hbr.org/2013/05/what-is-organizational-culture>
- <https://www.strategy-business.com/article/rr00006?gko=dab72>

Key characteristics of company culture

Innovation and risk-taking

The degree to which employees are encouraged to be innovative and take risks.

Attention to detail

The degree to which employees are expected to exhibit precision, analysis, and attention to detail. Outcome orientation. The degree to which management focuses on results or outcomes rather than on technique and process.

People orientation

The degree to which management decisions take into consideration the effect of outcomes on people within the organization.

Team orientation

The degree to which work activities are organized around teams rather than individuals.

Aggressiveness

The degree to which people are aggressive and competitive rather than easy-going.

Stability

The degree to which organizational activities emphasize maintaining the status quo in contrast to growth.

Examples of companies with great company culture

According to (Enplug), these are the break-downs and reviews of the different company cultures.

Wrike

Wrike is another company that puts a great deal of emphasis on hiring for culture, which is likely why it has glowing reviews on Glassdoor and was named one of the best places to work by the San Francisco Business Times. The project management software company does cross-team interviews to ensure a good fit and regularly blogs about culture. The entire team even got to take a trip to Mexico for four days of team-building and learning.

Creativity and feedback are encouraged at Wrike, where the attitude is “if you think it’s a good idea, go for it.” The team also makes a point of celebrating successes. As founder and CEO Andrew Filev tells Enplug:

“We always make sure to take the time to celebrate each other’s wins. In sales, it’s obvious: closing a big deal means bringing in money for the company. But other teams have different measures of success and we are careful to recognize those too,” and that includes personal accomplishments.

Why we love it: Wrike gives employees the autonomy to create a culture they love. Andrew’s advice on doing just that: “Make sure your employees know that being a great workplace is one of your goals as a business leader. They’ll be more than happy to help you create it.” Well said!

Quora

Quora is all about learning, conversation, and discovery. So it only makes sense, then, that the question-and-answer website’s employees are constantly learning and improving. At Quora, new hires are paired with mentors, and by the end of the first week, engineers and designers are reviewing one another’s code and deploying their creations.

In fact, continuous deployment—where new code is shipped out constantly—is the norm. Constant feedback from peers helps ensure the code keeps improving, and it helps employees learn from one another. Employees get regular one-on-ones with managers starting from day one, and everyone on the team has the chance to work with one another as teams vary by project.

Quora employees are also treated regularly to yoga sessions, free meals and company swag, and movie nights and morale events keep the team happy and engaged. On “one-hour project days,” everyone on the team spends their day doing a set list of tasks—like bug fixes—that can each be accomplished within an hour. The team races to complete each task, listening to music all the time, and celebrating at the end.

How do employees learn company culture?

As stated by (csus) we can see that employees learn about the culture in the following ways.

Stories

(ex. Nordstrom and car tires, Microsoft and “calling in rich”, and Krispy Kreme’s “minister of culture”)

Rituals

This will refer to the repetitive sequence of activities expressing and reinforcing key values

Material Symbols

To convey to employees what is important, who holds power and what kinds of behaviour are appropriate

Language

Here we see that employees will identify members of cultures or subcultures, if used by all then it’s accepted and preserved

Tips and tricks for successful change management

As stated by (rootinc)

- Follow a process. ...
- Start with the executives. ...
- Consider the needs and perceptions of all stakeholders in the change process. ...
- Pay attention to the individual change process. ...
- Focus on managers. ...
- Effectively handle resistance. ...
- Celebrate early wins. ...
- Sustain the dialogue.

Features of successful change management

Human-centric

We see that companies take a human-centric approach to change management. As a result, employees feel valued and involved. Employees feel like they have been considered and that they are valued by the company

The top management has made a commitment.

“Because change is inherently unsettling for people at all levels of an organization, employees will typically look to senior management for strength, support, and direction when change is upon them. As such, successful change strategies typically secure the full commitment of organization leaders before a planned change is even announced. These leaders are then expected to model the desired new behaviours, and, in doing so, challenge and motivate the rest of the institution.” (Valtech)

Leaders are involved:

It's not left to the employees to figure out what is happening. Leaders and managers jump in to help at all levels. Leaders and managers have the strategies in place to communicate, lead change, and work with employees.

Employees are encouraged:

Employees are consulted during the different stages of the change. Employees are able to voice their concerns, share ideas, and be part of the solution. Change is never easy but as managers and leaders, you can set up processes and systems that will help employees and the company.
